

HOPE



HOPE

Using Autoethnographic Methods to Design an Interactive video Installation.

Anton Tonnesen-Lucas: 20214322

Ina Jessen: 20123691

Luna Annabell Linné Jensen: 20213072

Matilde Wendy Stefania Jensen: 20216069

Art and Technology - 4. Semester

Duration: 13/02/23 - 31/05/23

ECTS: 15

Supervisor: Brian Bemman

Characters: 77.070

Pages: 32,1



**AALBORG
UNIVERSITY**

Abstract

[English]

The number of patients in the Danish Psychiatric system has grown exponentially, but the number of resources has not followed this growth. This has resulted in a psychiatry that has a lot of shortfalls, affecting people in the system, leaving them with interesting stories worth being told. Autoethnographic research is used for including personal experiences in a project, but it entails that the researchers themselves have first-hand experience with the research topic explored. This may not always be the case. In this paper we present the installation *HOPE*, which tells the story of a personal experience in the Danish psychiatric system incorporating video, sound, and interaction. The installation is the physical result of an exploration of whether instructing someone to do an autoethnographic self-reflection and then using this data for researching artists to design an interactive-video installation and if this can be a valuable method.

In order to test this, interviews and autoethnographic-inspired self-reflections, by people with first-hand experience, were completed and used to design the installation. It was evaluated by asking the participant, whose self-reflection the installation was based on, if they felt it was an accurate representation. Furthermore, we evaluated visitor's questionnaire answers with the intention of whether our interpretation of the self-reflection was successfully conveyed to them. Our results indicate that it is possible to create a video-installation based on someone else's autoethnographic account with successful outcomes.

This work serves as a contribution on how to use the autoethnographic accounts of other people in an artistic context. At the same time, it serves to create awareness about the stories of the individuals in the Danish psychiatric system. It will be possible to scale the installation up and expand with more stories, using the same method.

[Danish]

Antallet af patienter i den danske psykiatri er vokset eksponentielt, men antallet af ressourcer har ikke fulgt denne vækst. Dette har resulteret i en psykiatri, med mange betydelige mangler, som påvirker mennesker i systemet og efterlader dem med interessante historier, der fortjener at blive fortalt.

Autoetnografisk forskning anvendes til at inkludere personlige oplevelser i et projekt, men det forudsætter, at forskerne selv har førstehåndserfaring med de forskningsemner, der undersøges. Dette er ikke altid tilfældet. I denne rapport præsenterer vi installationen *HOPE*, som fortæller en historie om en personlig oplevelse i det danske psykiatriske system ved at inkorporere video, lyd og interaktion. Installationen er det fysiske resultat af en undersøgelse af, om det at instruere nogen i at foretage en autoetnografisk selvrefleksion er værdifuldt, og derefter bruge denne data, som kunstneriske forskere, med henblik på at designe en interaktiv video installation.

For at teste dette blev der gennemført interviews, og autoetnografisk inspirerede selvrefleksioner, af personer med førstehåndserfaring, blev brugt til at designe installationen. Det blev evalueret ved at spørge deltageren, hvis selvrefleksion installationen var baseret på, om de følte, at det var en troværdig repræsentation. Desuden evaluerede vi besøgendes besvarelser af spørgeskemaer med henblik på at afgøre, om vores fortolkning af selvrefleksionen blev formidlet til dem på en succesfuld måde. Vores resultater tyder på, at det er muligt at skabe en video-installation baseret på en andens autoetnografiske beretning med succesfulde resultater.

Dette arbejde bidrager til, hvordan man kan bruge andre menneskers autoetnografiske beretninger i en kunstnerisk kontekst. Samtidig skaber det opmærksomhed omkring historierne fra individer i det danske psykiatriske system. Det vil være muligt at udvide installationen med flere historier ved hjælp af samme metode.

Table of contents

Abstract.....	2
1 Introduction.....	6
2 Related Work.....	7
2.1 Artworks.....	7
2.1.1 Hearing Voices of Support, 2017	7
2.1.2 Black Out, 2019	9
2.2 What Does Interaction Contribute to an Artwork?	10
2.3 Qualitative Research Methods.....	11
2.3.1 Interviews as A Preliminary Research Method	11
2.3.2 Grounded Theory	12
2.3.3 Autoethnography.....	14
2.4 Structuring a Film Narrative and Using Animation as A Tool.....	18
2.5 Method of Evaluation	20
2.5.1 Questionnaires.....	20
3 Design process	21
3.1 Preliminary Interviews for Research	23
3.1.1 Preparation for The Interviews	23
3.1.2 Analysing the Interviews and Finding Patterns.....	23
3.2 Brainstorming of Ideas	24
3.3 Interaction Concept	25
3.4 Applying Autoethnographic Methods	26
3.4.1 Self-reflections	26
3.4.2 Results from the data	30
3.5 Design and planning of video	33
4 Implementation of <i>HOPE</i>	35
4.1 Video	35
4.2 Artefact	39
4.3 The Space and Exhibition Set-Up	42
5 Evaluation and discussion.....	45
5.1 Evaluation of participant 3	45
5.1.1 Preparation of Questions	45
5.1.2 Answers and Discussion	45
5.2 Evaluating Visitors of the Installation.....	47
5.2.1 Preparation of Questionnaires	47
5.2.2 Data from Questionnaires.....	48
5.2.3 Problem with the Questionnaire	49
5.2.4 Observations of the Interactions.....	50
5.3 Synthesising of Evaluation Answers	51
6 Future work	52
7 Conclusion	53
8 References	54

1 Introduction

In 2015, the Sustainable Development Goals were adopted by the members of the United Nations.

The goals are formulated as

... an urgent call for action by all countries - developed and developing - in a global partnership. ... They recognize that ending poverty and other deprivations must go hand-in-hand with strategies that improve health and education, reduce inequality, and spur economic growth – all while tackling climate change and working to preserve our oceans and forests. (*THE 17 GOALS | Sustainable Development*, u.å.)

Within the scope of the third goal of Good Health and Well-being is target 3.4: “By 2030, reduce by one third premature mortality from non-communicable diseases through prevention and treatment and promote mental health and well-being”. (*Goal 3 | Department of Economic and Social Affairs*, u.å., s. 3) This target partially inspired this project, together with personal interest and second hand experiences with the Danish psychiatric system.

Various sources express that within the Danish psychiatric system there exists problems like long wait times (*Patienter må stå i kø over et år*, 2022), feelings of hopelessness and general frustration with the system. This led to our research on how we through autoethnography and artistic practice can explore these problems. Even though none of us had any first-hand experience, we still wanted to create a work that had the same closeness and expressiveness that an autoethnographic work can provide. This led to the following problem statement:

Is it possible to use another person's autoethnographic self-reflection to create a true representation of their experience with the Danish psychiatric system, through a interactive-video installation?

In this report we will present our instillation *HOPE* which is designed to evaluate whether we are able to use autoethnographic self-reflection to create a true representation of a participant, with

first-hand experience of the psychiatric system, experience. More specifically, we created a video installation that only allows visitors to explore the interpretation of one experience in the Danish psychiatric system if they interact with a watering can. We evaluate this by an interview with the participant that helped create this installation, as well as a general evaluation with the visitors, using questionnaires.

In section [2]: “related works” we explore different artworks that inspired our project, we dive into what interaction is and why it is relevant for our artwork. We define what qualitative research methods we use, including Grounded Theory, interviews and autoethnography. Finally, we talk about what we use for evaluating our work. In section [3] we describe the process of designing *HOPE* In this section we collect preliminary data through interviews, brainstorm our interaction concept and end with how we apply the autoethnographic methods. In the section [4]: “implementation of *HOPE* we explain how the different designs were implemented into our interaction concept, and how the exhibition unfolded. Towards the end of this report in the section [5] “evaluation and discussion,” we review the data from our participant and the visitors at the exhibition, analyse the data and discuss the result. Finally, we discuss future work and conclude, with the section [6] and [7].

2 Related Work

This chapter will contain some examples of installations that deal with representation of personal individual experience, and methods used for collecting data for preliminary research. Furthermore, we will present methods for designing an interactive video-installation and for evaluating the reception of such an installation.

2.1 Artworks

2.1.1 Hearing Voices of Support, 2017

Hearing Voices of Support, as seen on figure 1, is an interactive art experience about schizophrenia that incorporates video and sound. The installation aims to disclose what it feels like to live with

the disorder and to remove stigma. Visitors can place themselves so they, through directional speakers, can hear an interview with a person afflicted with schizophrenia. A video of the interview is at the same time being projected onto the wall in front of the visitor (Fowler, Ian, 2017).



Figure 1 Visitors standing under the directional speakers and being shown a video of the interview.

The point of this installation is to further the awareness of what it feels like to have schizophrenia. It gives people with schizophrenia a voice and an opportunity to share their stories, and it gives visitors the opportunity to reflect and understand and to learn something new, “Visitors commented that the experience helped them truly hear each person’s story, so they were better able to understand and empathise with what these individuals had been through.” (Howard-Butler, 2017)

This artwork inspired us to make a collection of movie works with different stories from people that had experience with being in the Danish psychiatric system. Similarly, we wanted to work with very personal stories, told by the people themselves.

2.1.2 *Black Out, 2019*

Black Out, as seen in figure 2, is an immersive installation that features a standing podium, surrounded by a curtain of programmed LED-strips. Standing on the podium, you will be able to see a video work and hear accompanying sounds. Along with this and the programmed lights, the installation simulates a day in the life of the artist, as she experiences the mania and depression of Bipolar type II.

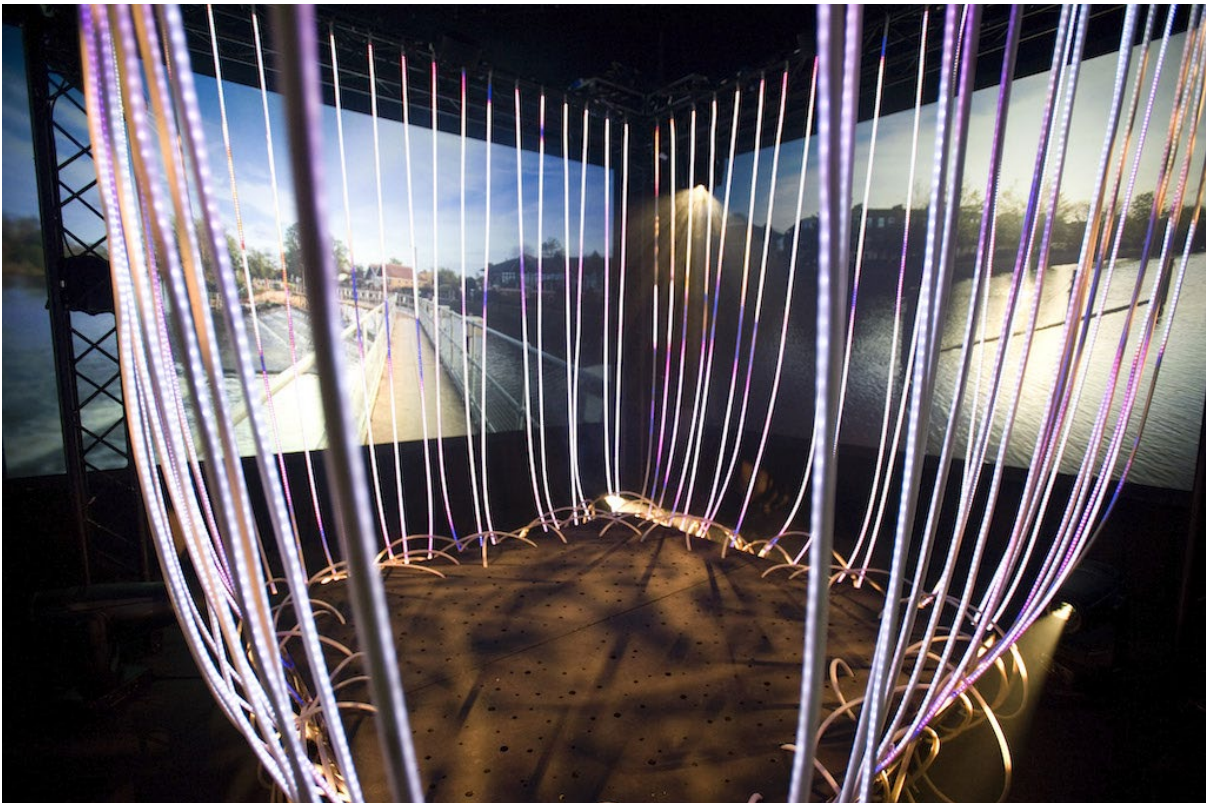


Figure 2 *Vibrating platform on which the visitor can stand, while lights, sounds and video creates an immersive experience.*

Mig Burgess created this installation to further the understanding of bipolar disorder, “Blackout Immersive was created to address the fundamental gap in understanding between those with mental health challenges and those without.” (*Fuse Arts*, u.å.)

Just as Burgess portrays a very personal experience by the aid of multiple elements, we wanted to highlight a very personal experience through an installation.

2.2 What Does Interaction Contribute to an Artwork?

To build an interactive artwork, you need to understand what interaction is, and why it is useful in the context of a project. Finding one definition of interactivity is hard, since different fields have different definitions of what interaction is. In Ahmed's article "Interaction and Interactivity: In the Context of Digital Interactive Art Installation" (Ahmed, 2018) he lays out the different ways interaction changes based on the field, in hopes researchers can use it more efficiently in digital based artworks (Ahmed, 2018, s. 255). He explains that interactive art becomes interactive when participation in and around the artwork is integral to the artwork. The actions the audience takes should be able to change the artwork. A part of the design essence should be how to achieve this interaction (Ahmed, 2018, s. 243).

One of the main effects of interactivity is described by fellow artist Masaki Fujihata. Fujihata describes the effects of interaction as a "digital networking system." What he means by this is the experience changes, the interactive work makes the viewer a participant, a "client." The artist becomes the "server," creating the interaction. It immerses the viewer in a dynamic system, creating a system that helps the viewer "experience" the artwork. Further deepening understanding and reflections of the artwork (Fujihata, u.å., s. 316–317). We intend to use these principles to create an emotional immersion.

Furthermore, the artwork needs to create active engagement. In tandem with interaction, our work therefore takes the concept of affordance into account. Affordance is originally a word derived from psychology. It describes the actionable properties between a person and the world around them, meaning the visible or invisible properties of objects that inform the people around them of how to use or interact with them (Norman, 1999, s. 39). It's about finding the relationships between objects and people, and designing based on these relationships, to create better and more concise design.

2.3 Qualitative Research Methods

2.3.1 *Interviews as a Preliminary Research Method*

In this project, interviews were used as a part of the preliminary research, to create a basis of knowledge of first-hand experiences.

Interviewing people is an effective method to collect first-hand accounts and opinions, “an effective way of soliciting and documenting, in their own words, an individual’s or group’s perspectives, feelings, opinions, values, attitudes, and beliefs about their personal experiences and social world, in addition to factual information about their lives”(Saldaña, 2011, s. 32). For example, if you want to investigate what it feels like to be involved in the Danish psychiatric system, it is valid to ask people that are familiar with it about their experience. When interviewing people about what they remember and what they think about a subject or experience, it is important to consider that the longer an experience sits in the past, the more difficult it is to recall the exact details and the emotions around it can grow stronger or weaker over time.

Saldaña writes in *Understanding Qualitative Research* (2011) that he does not recommend using familiar sources for interviews as you might make too many assumptions about what you think you know about your close relatives or friends. However, we chose to go ahead with our personal contacts, because we had a connection to people in the psychiatric system and we wanted to utilise that opportunity, because of the narrow time frame of the project. When having a narrow time frame, it can be convenient to use familiar sources which are readily available and that you already know to have experience within a certain field. Having to find qualified respondents can be a time-consuming procedure. Additionally, because these interviews only served as a way for us to explore which issues people experienced in the psychiatric system, as preliminary research, we determined that our familiarity with our interviewees would not harm our data. We tried to counter the bias slightly by analysing each other's interviews, so that the person connected to the interviewee was not the only one to analyse their interview.

We used semi-structured interviews with open-ended questions for this part of the process, as they gave more room for the interviewees to speak freely about their thoughts, feelings, and experiences. These types of interviews allow you to keep asking questions to make the participant elaborate on their thoughts, so a topic can be explored more in depth and misunderstandings can be lessened.

2.3.2 Grounded Theory

Within qualitative research, areas such as Grounded Theory are widely used. This term labels any method for systematic coding of data regardless of the composition of the study. This is not an actual theory but an approach to creating theory (Blandford et al., 2016, s. 69). It essentially consists of guidelines for collecting and analysing data to construct theories based on the data. There are many approaches to applying Grounded Theory. Researchers emphasise different aspects of Grounded Theory. Some have an emphasis on details in the coding process, others on the shifting in analysis between the details and the big picture. The approach that is most appropriate depends on the problem being addressed in the study and what works for the researcher (Blandford et al., 2016, s. 69).

Despite many different approaches, there is a consensus of what to involve when applying Grounded Theory. Firstly, there is the interleaving between data and analysis. In Grounded Theory, data drives the analysis, meaning the data collected influences the way of approaching the analysis, rather than pre-existing theory. The second aspect is avoiding the preconceived expectations, meaning avoiding forcing findings to fit into existing theories. Thirdly choosing participants, who will likely enhance the theory from the findings, therefore participants should be chosen with a theoretical basis, with the aim towards developing theory. Lastly a constant comparison between the findings to generate new insights and patterns (Blandford et al., 2016, s. 70).

2.3.2.1 Coding

In the previous section, systematic coding was mentioned. Coding itself often results in new and more abstract perspectives within the findings of a study. Common activities in coding are creating new codes, renaming existing codes, splitting codes, merging codes, creating hierarchy, and creating links (Blandford et al., 2016, s. 52).

Coding involves identifying units of data and giving them descriptions or labels. These can be used for spotting themes and patterns within a data set.

For this project coding was created within the systematic coding in Grounded Theory. The coding here is done with interleaving data and analysis in a circular approach consisting of; firstly, identifying the approximate coding, with the intention of finding common patterns and themes. At this point consistency was not important as themes and patterns do not need to match each other. In the first step, we looked through the preliminary interviews to find the general themes and patterns that gave us a loose idea of what directions to take in the next step.

The second step consisted of looking systematically through the findings of the first step, with the intention of finding promising or interesting themes for the analysis. At this step the consistency became more important. It is crucial to go back and forth between the themes and the big picture to ensure it continues being coherent.

The third step of the process includes building a narrative, where the themes are linked to an overall narrative. In this process re-coding may become necessary as themes are removed if they do not fit into the bigger picture. Understanding the themes and data is important, especially if themes may seem contradicting or certain aspects of data that might be missing, like if one participant does not mention a theme that may seem very important to others (Blandford et al., 2016, s. 53). In the third step, we went more narrowly into the findings, which meant closely looking for new findings or removing them when relevant. This meant circulating between the narrative and the identification of themes, repeatedly to become more precise. The following model (Figure 3), rooted in Grounded Theory, illustrates our approach to gathering and using the data provided by participants.

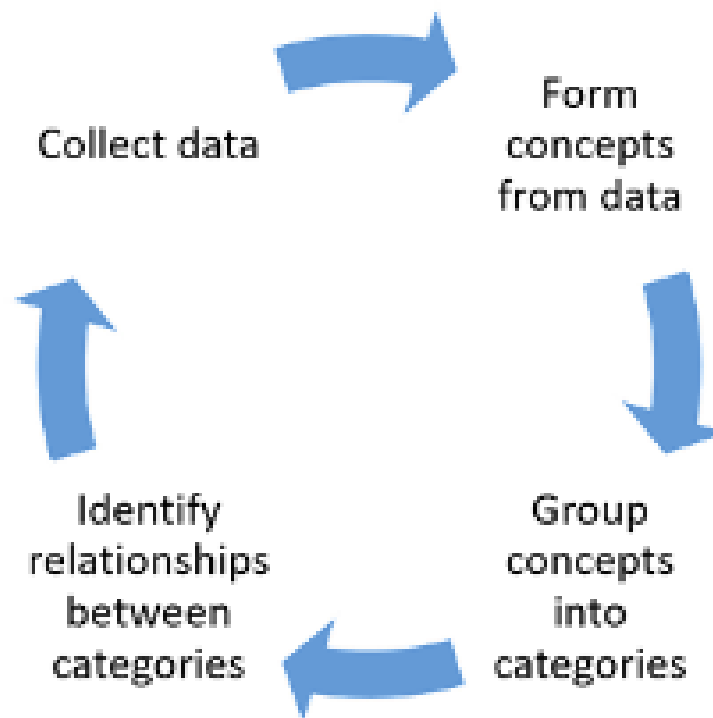


Figure 3 Process of grounded theory, Source: (Librarians, u.å.)

2.3.3 Autoethnography

Autoethnography is a research-method, based on the researcher's own lived experiences, for example memories, memorabilia, experiences, actions, feelings etc. It draws on this as its primary data and uses it as a form of probe, to expand and deepen the understanding of social phenomena (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 107). It takes something very abstract and creates a palpable meaning (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 540).

In more general terms it is about self-reflection, by reflecting on your own experiences and putting them up against socio-cultural phenomenon's, exploring differences and similarities, to create context and meaning for these phenomena. Self-reflection serves to gather data by either journaling or recording experiences on one's phone for later reflection. It involves collecting data directly from individuals. This process is referred to as self-observations, through which one can develop self-reflective data (Cooper & Lilyea, 2022).

One important aspect of self-reflection is pairing it with a broader perspective. We do not only want to know what we are feeling, but why, and because of what. It fills a gap in research and allows the researcher in question to add their own voice to the mix in a valid way (Cooper & Lilyea, 2022, s. 4).

Autoethnography is an ever-expanding field and researchers disagree on what kind of research it is. Within autoethnography you will find that several qualitative research traditions are used and drawn upon. Some include narrative research, autobiography, and art-based research (Cooper & Lilyea, 2022, s. 4).

As opposed to other research methods, autoethnographic research means extremely easy access to data, since you are the only person, you will need permission from, to gather this data. You are the central focus of the research. You can revisit your data whenever you need. This free access to data allows researchers to create very distinct work, contributing to the broader understanding of us humans in a socio-cultural context (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 108). This does not necessarily make the gathering of data easy, but finding and accessing the data could not be simpler. Even the fieldwork is simplified. It takes place in your home or office, at cafés, or on the street, anywhere you can create encounters and re-encounters with your own memories, objects and people (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 108).

It is also important to mention that autoethnography is a very open research method, it very much depends on your research topic, the method of which you gather your data, and the way you analyse your data. The process can vary greatly and create very different products.

2.3.3.1 Designing an Autoethnographic Study

To conduct autoethnographic research you first need a research topic. This can be drawn from both personal and professional interest in a topic but more commonly chosen from personal interest.

Paying close attention to your feelings and emotions can create topics for you to write about (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 110). Reflecting on what knowledge you want to create can help create a topic for you to reflect on (Cooper & Lilyea, 2022, s. 4). In this project, we found our reflection topics after analysing our preliminary interviews.

When you have chosen a topic, you need to consider the method of your research. More specifically whether the research will be conducted alone or with a group. Individual researchers just focus on their own personal experiences and work alone to create the final product. When working with collaborative autoethnography, you as a researcher have to consider the amount of people included in the study before starting the research(Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 111). Collaborative research can be done either “full” or “partial”, varying how involved the participants are in the study.

"Collaborative autoethnography can be carried out through 'full' collaboration, wherein researchers work together from the initial stages of data collection to the final writing process, or through 'partial' collaboration, where researchers collaborate at selected stages of the process"(Hernandez, 2016 as quoted in; Holman Jones et al., 2013). There exist both pros and cons for these methods. Individual studies also have the opportunity to go deeper and allow the author's skills to shine. On the other hand, individual studies are in danger of putting themselves on a pedestal. By making one perspective more important than others, you might lose important reflections. This con should be carefully considered when starting an autoethnographic study(Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 111).

In our study, the focus was on one individual perspective, as we wanted to showcase what it subjectively *can* feel like to be in the psychiatric system, rather than trying to show how everyone feels through one installation, as we cannot represent the feelings of all who are involved with the system, without reducing their feelings down to a single concept.

When you have decided on a topic and a method the next step is to gather the data. Now, there are multiple ways of gathering autoethnographic data. You can try to recall memories pertaining to your research topic, you can analyse yourself and your actions or observe yourself and what you do and think daily(Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 113). Most of the time you will use a mix of the different data-gathering methods.

When data has been gathered, it will need processing. One way of analysing autoethnographic data is through coding (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 116). After analysing the data, the product starts taking shape. The next step is to synthesise the data. Synthesising combines different components together. With the help of your synthesised coded data, you develop descriptive and analytical

themes (*Systematic Reviews*, 2023). You can use these themes to create a lot of different mediums; reports, poetry, songs, and films just to name a few (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 118). It is simply ready to be interpreted and be used as inspiration.

2.3.3.2 Autoethnography in an Artistic Context

Autoethnography is a tool that can help artists better dive into their personal experiences.

Understanding, communicating, and contextualizing their stories in disciplines such as visual art, film, drama, and performance studies (Holman Jones et al., 2013, s. 444). “Autoethnography has brought to the arts an embodied mode of inquiry that is sensuous, emotional, and intimate and a form of representation that is imaginative, evocative, and heartfelt” (Bochner & Ellis, 2003).

Autoethnography is already being used for these different artistic practices and is bringing the viewer one step closer to the personal experience of the artist. Autoethnography creates more intimate and emotional pieces of art that better showcases the lived experiences of the artist behind them. In this project, we look more closely at film. Autoethnography expressed in film are important research and teaching tools. The artist can actively engage the viewer through audio, visuals, plot, and sound by telling a story and more accurately communicating the autoethnographic story (Eisner, 1997, s. 26).

One of the problems of artistic autoethnography is the discrepancy that exists between the researchers using autoethnography, and the artists creating artworks. For example, a researcher might apply autoethnographic research to their own life, wanting the result to be a dance expressing his thoughts and feelings. Having no artistic experience the researcher’s product might end up being less than satisfactory (Finley, 2011).

A way of avoiding this is a collaboration, where the artist and the researcher come together to try and form a cohesive artwork, based on autoethnographic research. This kind of collaboration should create artworks of higher complexity and quality, but also expand the field and open it up to a hybridization between autoethnography and art. That cannot easily be defined, but can be explored and twisted, finding new ways of collaboration between the fields (Behar, 1999 and; Eisner, 1997).

This project experiments with a new way of this type of collaboration, where the researchers and artists are one and the same, while the data is collected from a willing participant with experience of a specific research topic. Testing whether or not this creates a satisfactory artistic expression.

2.4 Structuring a Film Narrative and Using Animation as a Tool

By utilising mediums, such as filmmaking, we aimed to express specific emotions and experiences. In this project we sought to translate personal accounts into a visual form.

When creating a video work based on a text, you need to identify what type of text you are working with. We identified the self-reflection as a poetic text, because of the language and non-linear storyline within the text.

According to Dick Higgins there are elements that illustrate how poetry challenges the traditional notion of linear structure, expanding beyond the limitations of verbal text, and highlighting the visual representation of language within the poem.

Dick Higgins identifies three characteristically spatial elements of visual poetry—the breaking of linearity, the transcendence of the verbal text, and a near separation of langue from parole (the quasi-division of signifying systems from concrete speech acts through an emphasis on the text as a visual object—what Higgins calls "an emblematic array of [text] images which embody a verbal message")(McAllister, 2014, s. 235)

By exploring these spatial elements, visual poetry opens new avenues for creative expression and interpretation, inviting readers to engage with language and meaning in innovative ways. Dickens explains how visual poetry deviates from the typical linear structure of text. Traditionally, words are arranged in a sequential manner, following a specific order from beginning to end. However, visual poetry breaks away from this linear arrangement. Moreover, when creating visual poetry, it goes beyond the limitations of traditional written language. While verbal text relies solely on written or spoken words to convey meaning, visual poetry incorporates visual elements, such as images, shapes, colours etc to enhance the expressive potential of the poem. By transcending the

boundaries of written language, visual poetry engages with the visual medium and expands the possibilities of communication and artistic expression. This is a very important part of our creation of the video since we are interpreting somebody else's both textual but also visual work. We wanted to use the non-linear approach from the visual poetry to convey the narrative in the video, as a means to preserve the stylistic choices in the self-reflection.

In our video installation, we employ animation as an element of our visual language, aiming to help convey an experience within the Danish psychiatric system. Animation serves as a great tool for conveying meaning and communicating abstract ideas effectively. By also incorporating sound, it further enhances the representation of ideas and evokes a range of emotions in the viewer, ultimately crafting a distinct and compelling experience. This is explained in the following quote.

To some extent, animation uses the visual language of live action cinema as novels use words. Animation conveys meaning and communicates abstract ideas such as emotion and experience, and it does so over the course of time by representing lines, shapes, colours and symbols - giving pace, rhythm and anticipation through apparent motion (Block 2007). Together with, or with absence of, sound, it can represent ideas and evoke emotions in the viewer, crafting an experience. (Vistisen, 2016, s. 48)

Furthermore, the quote suggests a comparison between animation and live action cinema, emphasising the visual language aspect. There are shared techniques as lighting, framing and camera movement to enhance or get a certain the viewer's experience. Animation uses the techniques differently but to acquire the same viewer experience.

The choice to add animated elements could ground in that with animation it can abstract concepts that are not able to exist in the physical world "animation can abstract concepts in a form that could not exist in the physical world." (Vistisen, 2016, s. 48)

By animating physical impossible objects, the animator can play with more abstract concepts to exaggerate meaning. "Through aesthetic and functional choices, the animator is able to condense, enhance, and even exaggerate meaning." (Vistisen, 2016, s. 49)

Animation also enables us to transcend the limitations that may arise in depicting certain concepts or experiences through other mediums, granting the freedom to explore imaginative realms and depict abstract ideas in ways that surpass the constraints of reality. This emphasises that animation offers a unique advantage by allowing artists and storytellers to surpass limitations that may be encountered when trying to convey certain concepts or experiences using other mediums.

2.5 Method of Evaluation

To evaluate this project, we interviewed the participant who was the focus of our autoethnographic study and used questionnaires to evaluate the people visiting the installation. The participant was evaluated by asking follow-up questions after the participant had interacted with the installation and the visitors were evaluated by questionnaires.

2.5.1 Questionnaires

Handing out questionnaires is an easy way to get both qualitative and quantitative data. In questionnaires, the participants can anonymously answer questions on their own, without a lot of guidance, and the answers will already have been written down, as opposed to when doing an interview (Gillham, 2008).

This approach worked well for this project, as the installation was exhibited publicly, and we had to host and guide people into our installation. Doing interviews would have posed a challenge, as we would have had to be in multiple places at the same time, and there was not a private space to interview people in, about the rather sensitive topic of the installation.

We used both quantitative and qualitative questions in our questionnaire. Quantitative questions are a quick way to obtain data for statistics and qualitative questions offer the possibility of writing a freer and in-depth expression of thoughts and opinions. Quantitative data can be used to effectively measure a change from before to after an interaction, by asking people to cross words (e.g., feelings) off on a list prior to an experience and ask them to do it again afterwards and measure the difference. The qualitative part can be used to give the respondent an opportunity to

express something that was not covered in the quantitative part, and thus the two parts complement each other well.

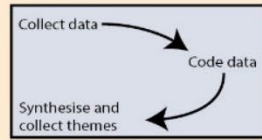
3 Design Process

In this section we provide an overview of the design of *HOPE*. We will describe the process leading us to the final concept, through gathering knowledge in the preliminary interviews. We will describe the choices made with the autoethnographic methods to create our installation. The model on the following page describes the design process (see figure 4). We started by making preliminary interviews, which were analysed through a Grounded Theory approach with the intention of gathering themes (see section [3.1]). The findings from the preliminary interviews were used in two directions. The first one being an interaction element [3.3], consisting of creating a concept. The second uses the preliminary findings as a basis in creating of the self-reflection [3.4]. The self-reflection was analysed with Grounded Theory to create material for the final concept of what becomes *HOPE*. The interaction influenced the elements that were found in the self-reflection. The interaction and self-reflections were then combined, and the concept was finalised. From this the interactive video-installation *HOPE* was created.

Guiding principles, theories and methods:

Autoethnography
Interaction
Grounded theory

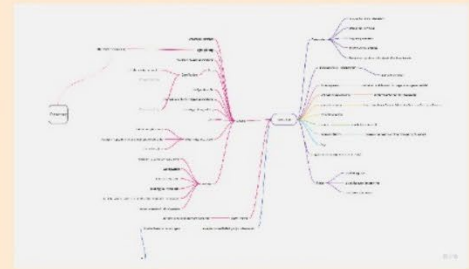
Interviews



Themes

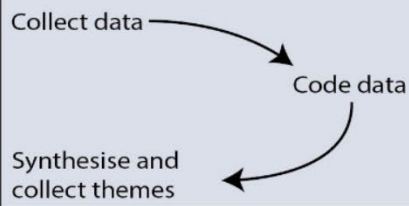
Interaction

- Brainstorm
- Interesting interactive elements
- Interaction concept

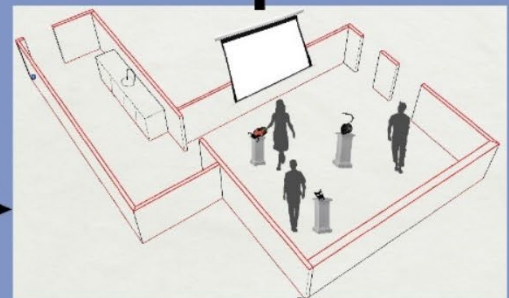


Themes

Self-reflection

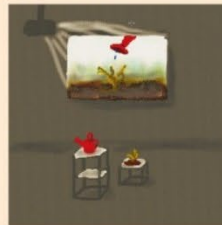


Brainstorm on applying themes to interaction concept



Final concept

- Combination of Self-reflection and interaction
- Sketches and drawings



Implimentation



"HOPE"

Figure 4 Our design process, visualized.

3.1 Preliminary Interviews for Research

To start our project, we needed to learn about the experiences of being in the Danish psychiatric system. Therefore, we conducted interviews with 5 people about their experiences with the Danish psychiatric system, as we did not want to assume what it felt like. By conducting interviews, we were able to get an insight to the perspectives, opinions, feeling personal experiences among other things, which enabled us to formulate our research topic. Each of the participants had a personal connection to the psychiatric system; four of them were or had been in the system, and one of them was next of kin.

These interviews were important for our general design, as they ended up informing our later brainstorming and reflections on this topic.

3.1.1 Preparation for The Interviews

In preparation of the interviews, questions were created based on our own assumptions and the knowledge we had previously acquired through related work, in the earliest stages of the project. The questions were generally formulated around subjective words such as “experienced”, “think” and “feel”, to prompt them to give their personal perspective. The interview questions were separated into three categories; the warm-up, where factual questions were asked about when their experiences with the psychiatric system started and whether they are still actively involved. The main body revolved around questions about their experiences and thoughts, and lastly there was a cool-off section, letting the participants add new thoughts or topics they might find relevant or emphasise certain parts of the interview (see appendix 1).

3.1.2 Analysing the Interviews and Finding Patterns.

To analyse the interviews, each of them were transcribed, and each group member looked at each interview searching for codes and patterns, as described in section [2.3.2] about Grounded Theory. The overarching theme of being in the Danish psychiatric system was already set. We constructed an analysis guide for all members of the group, to ensure that we each analysed the interviews in the same way (see appendix 2). In this guide, we established that we had to note down “strong”

expressive words, repetitions, the things the interviewees put emphasis on, things we found unusual or interesting, and words or sentences that described feelings of the interviewees. Following this, each analysis for each interview was held together to compare the results of general ideas, moods or themes emerging.

The themes emerging in the interviews were established as “time”, “frustration” and “help”. We found sentences like:

... det der gjorde det største indtryk på mig var hvor dårlig udredning var, og hvor lang tid det tog” and “i starten gik der meget lang tid med min datter, det var en kamp for at få hende diagnosticeret, udredt.

and coded them into a theme called time and we made the theme of frustration based on the general mood of the conversations and statements about not feeling heard or taken seriously. The theme of help emerged from sentences like “... hun (red. psykologen) kom alligevel hen og sagde at der var en overbelastning, de ville ikke tilbyde mig mere hjælp, og så brød jeg sammen...”.

These themes were then used as the guiding direction for the project, and later used to collect further data (see section [3.4].

3.2 Brainstorming of Ideas

After the preliminary interviews, we had decided on the research topic and theme. We then brainstormed on how to create an interactive-video installation. This meant looking into possible directions of interaction and interactive elements. We looked at elements such as light, video, mechanics and sound and what possibilities each of these had in relation to interactivity.

It was important for us to brainstorm on the interaction in an objective way, not letting the brainstorm be affected too much by the results of the preliminary interviews, because we wanted an interaction concept that was open and could be used for a lot of different themes.

We started looking into more concrete ideas about how to represent the themes. We looked into creating an impossible-to-win game, to indicate the feelings and frustrations of being in the system that some of the answers from the preliminary interviews indicated. Ultimately, we chose to step

away from the idea of gamification in the project, as we felt, gamifying the installation could too easily distract from what we really wanted to say, which was showing what it feels to be in the Danish psychiatric system. We did not want people to focus too much on playing a game instead of understanding the message.

"At this point of the process, we decided on using autoethnographic methods to portray these feelings of being in the system, and that became the main focus of our study."

We then looked at ways to create the interactive component in our installation and came up with the idea of creating an artefact that could be interacted with to influence another part. This very simple form of interaction seemed very powerful as many things could be done with it, while not taking focus away from the message of the project.

3.3 Interaction Concept

We ended up settling on the two different elements that would make up our final concept: an artefact and a video. The concept was simple. A visitor would enter the room, and interacting with an artefact would trigger a video tied to that specific object (see figure 5 below). The original concept included space for multiple artefacts and interactions in case we wanted to expand the installation.

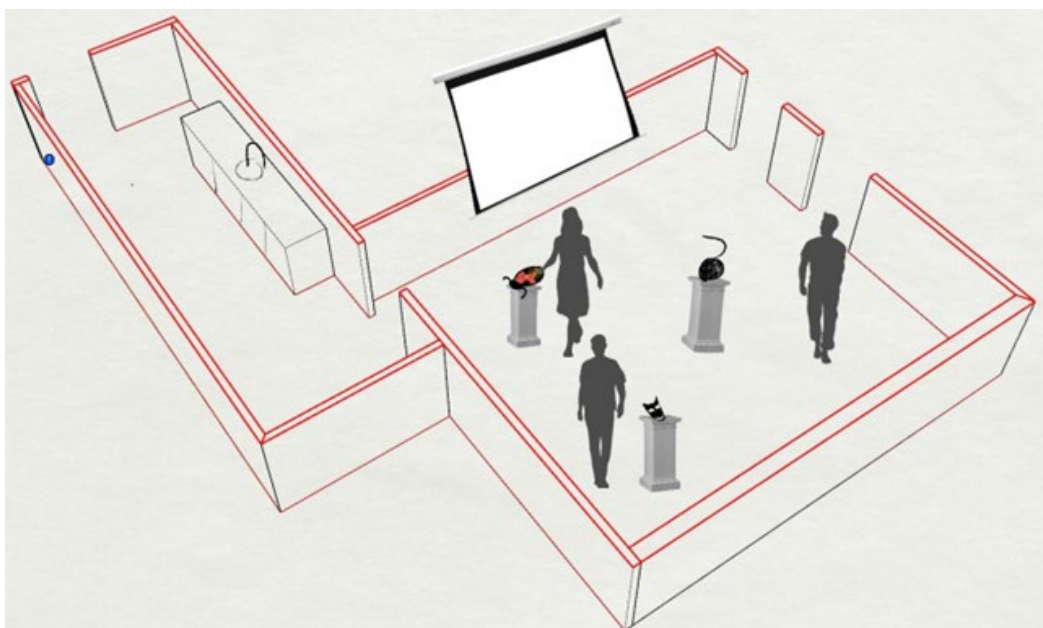


Figure 5 shows a sketch of the initial concept, at its beginning.

The artefacts would be made in the form of physical manifestations of something relating to the participants in our study. An important objective of these objects would be to create affordance and give the viewers a motivation to interact. The artefacts were meant to act as a link between the visitor and the story displayed, deepening the immersion.

For our video we wanted to base the content of the video on autoethnographic data gathered from a participant. Video works are one of the several ways you can showcase autoethnographic data, as mentioned in Holman's text (2013). To convey the feelings explained by the participant we wanted to edit the video with a poetic style, which uses atmospheric and sensuous setups. The process of making the video is explained in detail in section [3.5] and [4.1]

3.4 Applying Autoethnographic Methods

Having settled on the concept of the interaction we needed to explore how to finalise the finished concept. Our research question was circling around *how* autoethnographic methods could be used to create true representations of peoples lived experiences, inside the Danish psychiatric system, with the end goal being an interactive-video installation. We needed to craft a way of extracting Autoethnographic data from someone with experience with the Danish psychiatric system. As none of us had first-hand experience with seeking psychiatric help, we wanted to apply this autoethnographic method by instructing others in creating a self-reflective autoethnographic account for us to use.

To do that, we made a self-reflection guide so someone with little to no knowledge of autoethnography would be able to use it and create meaningful and usable autoethnographic data.

3.4.1 Self-reflections

We have previously explained how the autoethnographic method can be utilised. In this section, we will discuss our utilisation of self-reflections in our research.

The method of 'self-reflections' enables participants to reflect on their own experiences and document them in writing and in a visualisation.

For our project we wanted to use self-reflections as a means of gathering data for the final concept. However, as we were not the ones self-reflecting, we decided to create a guide for the participants with few constraints and open-ended questions, fostering an environment where they did not feel forced into a particular state of mind (see appendix 3).

Our project is using the reflections in a different way than traditionally, as we as researchers are not the ones self-reflecting, instead this area has been transferred to a participant, and our role then consists of interpreting the reflection and conveying their message through our artistic interpretation.

3.4.1.1 The Self-reflection Guide

To gather data from our participant, we developed a self-reflection guide that would provide them with guidance on how we wanted them to share their knowledge and reflections. The guide consisted of two sections: (1) a text reflection and (2) a visual reflection.

The text reflections were narrowed down to revolve around the three key themes that emerged from our initial preliminary interviews. The three emerging themes were:

- Time
- Frustration
- Help

We encouraged participants to approach this task freely and without excessive constraints to avoid any sense of feeling forced. Therefore, the text reflection component included the freedom to choose which writing style they felt most suitable to express their reflections. This meant we received different types of writing including a poetic styled reflection and two descriptive reflections.

For the visual reflections, participants were asked to visualise their thoughts using various visual mediums, such as collages, photography, drawings, images from the internet, or any other suitable form.

3.4.1.2 Analysis of the Self-reflection Texts

Within our appendix (see appendix 4), we present the framework we made for analysing the reflections. Initially, we focused on identifying recurring themes, strong words, and emphasised aspects in the self-reflections. This allowed us to find patterns and common threads within the data.

Subsequently, we engaged individually in a brainstorming session to explore ways of translating these themes into visual materials that would harmonise with the overall artefact. By brainstorming individually, we would be able to minimise bias and collect many different ideas. After this step we synthesised the results together. Together we carefully analysed the data and derived individual concepts from it. Next, we organised our findings into distinct categories, clearly illustrated in our overall design model (see figure 4), representing different steps of the process. Finally, we established connections between these categories by providing our own interpretations. Out of the total of five participants, only three provided self-reflections. In their written reflections, each participant expressed their experiences with the Danish psychiatric system and the emotions it evoked in them, based on one of the three previously mentioned themes.

One participant expressed: "Jeg oplever, at tilfældighed er alt for centralt i psykiatrien... Jeg har tidligere haft behandlere som ikke gjorde noget godt for mig- tværtimod... Dette 'spil' er meget udbredt på sengeafsnittene, de lukker mange pladser ned i weekenden..." Furthermore, the participant describes how it feels as if the health professionals guess who are well enough to be sent home in a game like manner. From this participant's reflection, we deduced that the visual representation and the concept of a game could be relevant. The participant expresses the game Yahtzee would be like the feeling. We then discussed Yahtzee and dice games as potential ways to create awareness of the overall experience, but in the end, we concluded that it would not be the desired outcome in terms of what we wanted to conduct with our research, as we were conscious of whether gamifying the instillation would distract the viewers from seeing the themes and feelings described by the participant.

Another participant, who had a relative within the system, addressed the following: "Som pårørende oplever jeg stor frustration og ambivalens ift. hjælp. Jeg bliver tilbudt tidskrævende gruppeforløb på en psykiatrisk afdeling, hvilket jeg som pårørende ikke har tid og overskud til." From this reflection, we discerned the participants experience of lacking appropriate assistance. Despite being offered help in the form of group therapy, the participant feels unable to participate due to limited time and energy, as their presence is required for the well-being of the person they care for. We acknowledged that frustration is a prominent theme in this self-reflection. The participant used a picture analogy to visually depict the feeling of hopelessness and frustrations within the system in the following picture (see figure 6).



Figure 6 *Picture from participant's self-reflections*

The third participant crafted a poetic text to express their experience and contributed a painted picture, which ultimately became a part of the installation (see appendix 10 for participant 3's reflections)

In our formal analysis of the participants, we delved into the details of their reflections. As previously mentioned, our analysis process involved individual assessments followed by the synthesis of our collective data. During the formal analysis, we began by identifying highlighted themes, emphasised words, repetitions, and underlying emotions, employing Grounded Theory methodology as described in section [2.3.2] The following emerged as significant elements:

1. Time: The participant's reflection highlighted the constraint of time, implying a sense of urgency or limited availability.
2. Carelessness: The notion of carelessness surfaced, indicating a perception of inadequate attention or disregard within the system.
3. Don't expect help! This phrase captured the participant's scepticism or disillusionment concerning the effectiveness of receiving assistance.
4. Frustration: The reflection conveyed a prominent feeling of frustration, suggesting an overwhelming sense of dissatisfaction.
5. Ambivalence: The participant expressed a state of ambivalence, implying conflicting emotions or uncertainty regarding their role and involvement.
6. Coincidence: The concept of coincidence emerged, indicating a perception of randomness or chance within the system.
7. Inadequate: The reflection conveyed a sense of inadequacy, suggesting a feeling of insufficiency or lack of proper support.

Having identified these key elements, we proceeded with a brainstorming session to generate visual ideas to effectively translate the reflections into a cohesive video and artefact. This process aimed to ensure that the visual representations aligned with the essence of the participants' experiences and created a coherent narrative.'

3.4.2 Results from the Data

As we had to gather data individually before synthesising together, we did several different sketches for inspiration to see what could be a part of the final concept.

The significant elements described before, became areas of interest when brainstorming potential ideas. The sketch below (figure 7) is a sketched idea from participant 3's self-reflection, as they explain about "den altfortærende snegl". This sketch became the inspiration for one of the scenes in the final video. Section [3.5] and [4.1] describes the content of the video in detail.



Figure 7) Visualisation by one researcher of the all-devouring snail, described in participant 3's self-reflection.

We also conducted an analysis of the visual materials provided by the participant (see figure 8), employing pre-icon analysis techniques. Through this approach, we aimed to extract a comprehensive collection of objects depicted in the materials. This process proved valuable to us as it enabled us to derive inspirations for potential artefacts (see appendix 4).

Among the findings of both the text reflection and the visual reflection, we gathered several noteworthy items, including Snail, Psychiatrist, Soldier, Time, and Flower



Figure 8 Visual reflection by participant 3.

We used this information to create a video work. We incorporated both live action and animation to interpret and create a visual work from the self-reflection. As we have explained in section [2.4] the text was created in a poetic style which meant that structuring the video would be a lot more abstract since we did not follow a linear structure. The following picture (figure 9) showcases the final outcome for our concept. We opted for a watering can as we felt it represented the act of nourishing a dying flower in the hopes of its survival, as there are descriptions regarding growth of hope, and how the hope is hungry after water.



Figure 9 Sketch resulting from the discussion of artefact and video-combinations based on the analysis of the reflection.

3.5 Design and Planning of Video

When designing and planning a video we employed tools to make the workflow better. This section will go into detail on how every scene in the video was designed and with what tools.

Storyboarding serves as an essential tool that aids the artist in preparing an outline for desired storyline and visual presentation(LLC, u.å.). Our approach involved strategic planning of distinct key elements desired for each scene, followed by the creation of templates that depicted the intended visual composition. This method facilitated ease of editing during the final stages, ensuring a smoother production process. We planned out every scene in detail, and used these plans as a template of how it should look, to make the editing easier in the end. We created the video based on live-action scenes together with animated scenes, to best convey our imagery. These plans include the use of mood boards, which contributed to the visual aesthetics and atmospheric qualities of the video. Below we are showing our mood board for the doctor's office (figure 10). This was to have an idea of how we wanted the initial scene to look like. As participant 3 did not make a description of their experience of the doctor's office, we decided on the design of the physical space. The mood board shows one of the scenes planned for the video.



Figure 10 mood board of doctor's office

The main plot revolves around a patient in a doctor's office, drawing inspiration from the following self-reflection text: "Hvert monotone spørgsmål fra den ligeglade psykolog, der ikke ænsede slimen i mit sind." This quote captures the monotonous nature of being questioned by an indifferent psychologist, who fails to acknowledge the turmoil within one's mind. The scene is set in a doctor's office, highlighting the repetitive and mundane experience.

Another excerpt from the self-reflection text describes the gradual loss of hope: "Det før blomstrende håb tvinges ned hurtigere end tidligere – det er hårdere at miste håb når man har ladet det gro, end når det i forvejen er visnet, hungrende efter vand." This passage emphasises how hope, that was once flourishing, is forced to fade away faster than before. It conveys the difficulty of losing hope when one has nurtured it, as opposed to when it was already withered and desperate for revival.

The text further explores the impact of depression: "Som en altfortærende snegl greb depressionen om min hjerne og spiste bid for bid." It vividly portrays the all-consuming nature of depression, comparing it to an all-devouring snail that engulfs the mind, consuming it piece by piece. As this depiction is very abstract, we decided to utilise 3d animation to create this scene.

Additionally, the concept of being trapped in a limbo is expressed: "Fanget i et limbo." This phrase reflects the feeling of being caught in an inescapable state, where time seems to stand still. It signifies the sensation of being suspended in a perpetual state of uncertainty and stagnation. Again, this concept is very abstract, so we decided to use animation to visualise this scene as well. We found that all of us got the feeling of "limbo" from our participants own painting and decided to use this as a base for our animation.

Finally, we created a scene based partially of this quote: "Hvordan kan en soldat, der har fået skudt benet af, forbinde det og sørge for der ikke går betændelse i såret uden en andens hjælp?" A general thematic occurrence in the text, is that of a soldier standing in for the participants experiences. This quote emphasises the soldier's struggle to tend to their wounded leg and prevent infection without assistance, serving as a metaphor for the difficulties faced by individuals within the system and the

need for professional support. We wanted the scene to showcase a literal interpretation of this metaphor. Showing a scene with a wounded soldier being ignored and left on his own. These findings will then be made into the final project, as described in the next section.

4 Implementation of *HOPE*

In this section we would like to provide an overview on how the installation was physically constructed. *HOPE* is designed as an interactive installation that aims to provide an experience about the Danish psychiatric system. After researching and using different autoethnographic methods we were going to make an installation that encompasses the themes.

4.1 Video

The 3d animation was animated in Maya (*MAYA*, u.å.) and Clip Studio Paint (*Clip Studio Paint*, u.å.), drawing inspiration from our sketches and data.

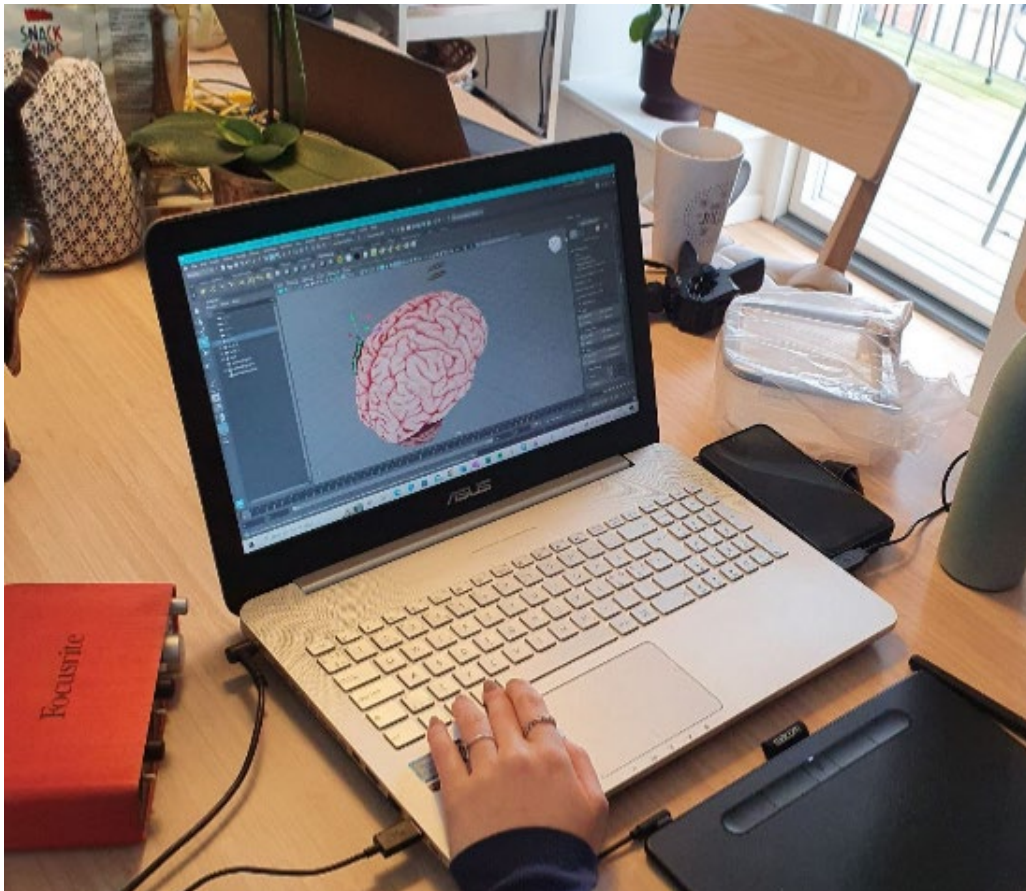


Figure 11 Picture of brain animation in development



Figure 12 Still frame of 3D brain animation.



Figure 13 Still frame of 2D clock animation.

We used a canon 77D camera and a Gopro to film all our scenes, we used Final Cut Pro as our picture editing software and Logic Pro to edit sound. It was filmed in 16:9 aspect ratio and in 1920x1080 resolution, this was to get the best quality for the video.

The flower was filmed outside, and the rapid death of the flower was filmed over a duration of 10-minutes, using a heat gun to slowly kill it. For the scenes where the flower resurrects, the footage is played backwards.



Figure 14 *Process of killing our flower.*

The soldier scenes were filmed at “Kridtsløjfen” in Aalborg. The area is full of gravel and mud, and is very desolate, giving it a look of a war-torn area. The soldier needed to look injured. Therefore, the costume was made by combining borrowed military clothing, and a pair of pants we tore and burnt to look damaged. Furthermore, we created a fake injured leg using silicone, makeup, and fake blood.



Figure 15 From left to right: Burning and destroying pants, On location at "Kridtsløjfen", Fake wound makeup.

The psychiatrist scenes were filmed in one of our homes. We made the room look as close to our mood boards as possible, and a costume for the psychiatrist was assembled using a turtleneck, lab coat and glasses.



Figure 16 Set of psychiatrist's office.

When entering the space and interacting with the installation, we initiated the playback of a video. This video was triggered by the watering of the flower, resulting in the creation of a water visual on the screen.

The video of the installation revolves around participant 3's self-reflection.

4.2 Artefact

The artefact was created based on the self-reflection data made by our participant. As a result of the synthesising data from the self-reflection the theme that came from the data was hope or the lack thereof. The imagery that was used to best describe this hope was that of a flower; withering and dying, until finally being watered and then left to die once again. We felt this imagery was ideal to design an artefact around.

The design of the artefact was split in two parts. The plant and the watering can. The plant we used was a yellow dahlia. This flower was chosen for two reasons, the lonely flower matched the imagery described earlier and the colour. Yellow has a general implication of optimism, and we see this as a commentary on how one can find hope and optimism that they might get the help they need. It was important for the plant to look *dying*, and not completely dead. We wanted the state of the plant to match the video, and simultaneously help the affordance. For this purpose, the plant was then blasted with a heat gun to make it look dried and dying. For the watering method we had decided on a watering can. We thought that by putting a watering can next to a dying plant it would be clear that the interaction was to water the dying flower. The red colour of the watering can was chosen simply because of its complementary colour to the green of the flower and because we found the red colour eye-catching.

Ideally you would be able to water the plant with real water from the watering can, and then start the video. However, this faced some issues. First, filling the watering can would require us to either have water ready for participants to use, or fill the can ourselves which would result in pausing the installation. We would need to find a solution for where the water would go since we did not have any buckets or restrooms close. Finally, the can needed to be equipped with sensors, and we were afraid of short-circuiting the electronics by accident. We decided to avoid this by creating a digital watering effect. The watering can could be tilted, and if it was tilted a certain amount, a watering graphic would play on top of the screen. We implemented this using a BNO055 directional sensor, (*Adafruit BNO055 Absolute Orientation Sensor*, u.å.) attached to a wireless micro-

controller(*M5Stack Atom Motion Kit*, u.å.), and the program Processing(*Fry & Reas*, u.å.). All information was transferred via OSC signal through a server we had set up. The software flow is shown in figure (17).

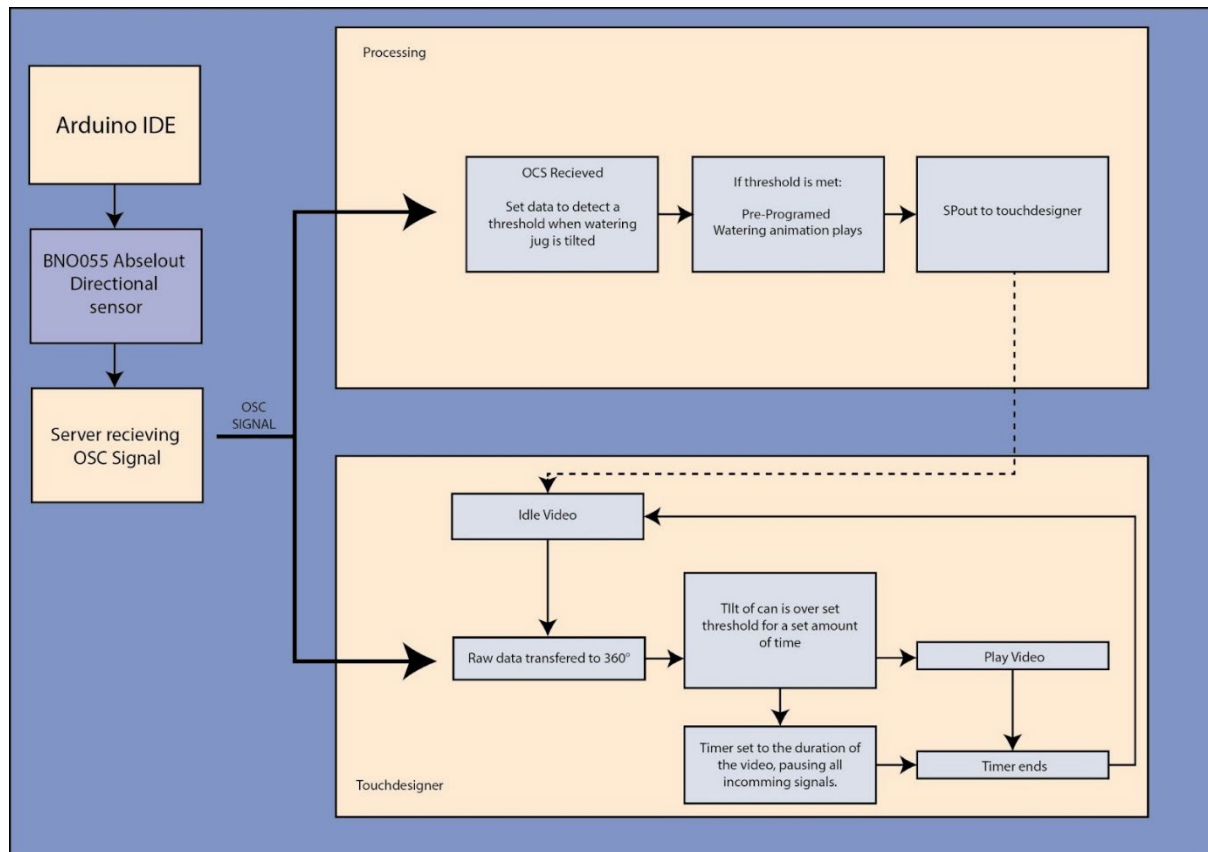


Figure 17 Software flowchart describing our programming of HOPE.

We started by fixing the sensor and microcontroller to the bottom of the watering can. The controller needed to be able to be removed for charging. Figure 18 shows a prototype we did, unfortunately it created too much of a visible bottom, we then had to come up with a different solution.



Figure 18 First prototype of false bottom

In the end we found the best and easiest result was taping the sensor to the bottom and covering the interior with red cloth to cover the electronics and creating the illusion the watering can was empty. This is shown in figure 19 below.



Figure 19 Showcasing of final watering can, hiding the electronics with a piece of cloth.

The video was then triggered using the program TouchDesigner(*TouchDesigner*, u.å.).

TouchDesigner, being a visual programming software, is easy to showcase as seen in the figure 20 below. In order to create the watering effect, we created an animation in processing. Setting up simple particles to fall on the screen when the watering can was tilted. The code for this watering effect can be found in the appendix 5.

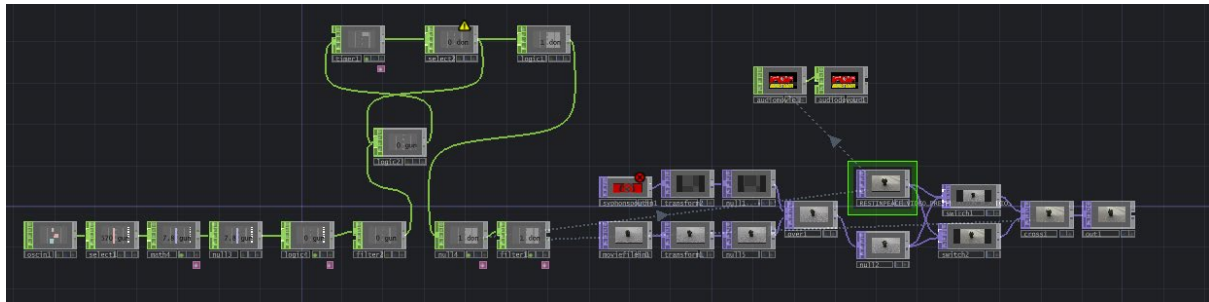


Figure 20 Overview of our TouchDesigner file

To view the codes of TouchDesigner see appendix 6.

The program first took sensor data from a directional sensor (*Adafruit BNO055 Absolute Orientation Sensor*, u.å.) and converted it into 360°. Making us able to create a boolean of 0 and 1 when the sensor was tipped over a certain threshold. A filter then stretched this boolean over 3 seconds, so the sensor would need to be tipped for 3 seconds for a 1 to occur. A loop would then go into effect, making sure the video would play, and not reset before it was over. After the video was done it would convert back to the standby video.

4.3 The Space and Exhibition Set-Up

The installation was exhibited at a public exhibition at Aalborg University.

The space ended up being fairly closed off. The first thing visitors would be met with was a lit-up wall with posters about our work and descriptions of the thoughts put into the project. Underneath this we had a station set up for answering our questionnaire (see figure 21).

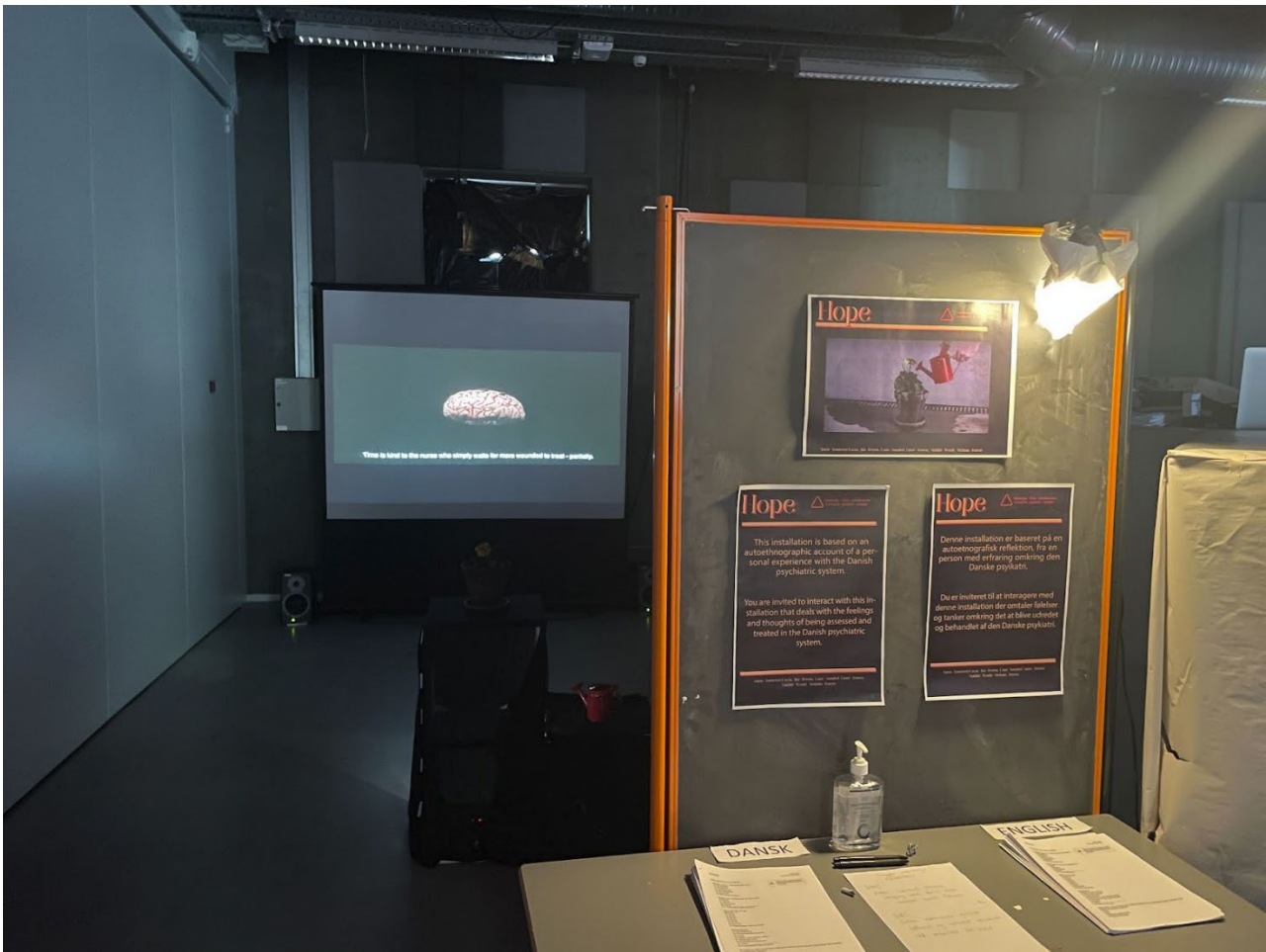


Figure 21 Picture from our Exhibition, showcasing the entrance to our installation.

Moving left from the posters, the room was small and long, with the pedestal standing in the middle of the room. The artefacts standing on top of the pedestal, and a screen playing a video in the back of the room, with two speakers on each side. The pedestal was covered in a black cloth to not draw attention to the electronics. Likewise, the cables running from the pedestal were taped down with black tape and all the electronics were hidden underneath the cloth and pedestal. To draw the attention and focus to the pedestal and the screen. The electronics, previously mentioned, consisted of four things. A computer to run TouchDesigner and Processing, a router, a projector, and a light hooked up to make a spotlight on the watering can. Furthermore, the speakers' cables ran from the pop-up screen to the pedestal and were taped down. The room can be seen in figure 22.



Figure 22 *Picture from the exhibition, showcasing our installation.*

We made a wall of tables and covered it with paper to barrier the rest of the room - cutting our room off from the other artworks in the room.



Figure 23 *Picture showcasing construction of the wall. The wall was made by stacking tables on top of each other.*

Afterwards they were covered in large sheets of paper.

5 Evaluation and Discussion

To evaluate whether using the autoethnographic account of another person had successfully enabled us to create a true representation of their thoughts and feelings, we set up a two-part evaluation. The first part was asking the provider of the autoethnographic self-reflection about their opinion and for the second part, we handed out questionnaires to visitors of the installation.

5.1 Evaluation of participant 3

5.1.1 Preparation of Questions

We posed the participant two questions, after they had interacted with the installation and seen the video. The questions were short and concise (see figure 24). We wanted to know if we had successfully conveyed their experience.

Do you recognise your own experience in the installation?
If yes, how?

If not, what things stood out to you as non-representative of your experience?

The answer can be a mix of both yes and no.

Figure 24 These questions participant 3 was asked to reflect on, after the exhibition.

5.1.2 Answers and Discussion

We posed the questions electronically and got an answer back from Participant 3 online as well, see appendix 7 for the full answer.

We asked them if they could recognise their experience in the installation, and they said, “Ja, jeg relaterede især til psykologscenerne hvor der ikke mærkes nogen forståelse eller varme.” They thought that the monotonous

coldness of the interaction between the psychiatrist and the patient in the video was very relatable to them. This response supports the notion that the installation successfully conveyed the intended message and resonated with them. The participant also said, “Jeg kan godt relatere til skuespillerens gestikulationer og mimik for det føles virkelig drænende og ligegyldigt”. Participant 3 appreciated the actor's gestures and facial expressions in the installation, as they conveyed that he found the situation draining and felt he was being treated indifferently, which aligned with their own experience. This indicates that the performance effectively portrayed the emotions and atmosphere of the interaction between the psychiatrist and the patient. The participant noted, “Jeg kunne godt lide brugen af animationerne og følte at det understregede mine pointer ret godt og hjalp til at visualisere dem.” The use of animations in the installation was well-received by Participant 3. They felt that the animations served to emphasise their points effectively and aided in visualising them. This positive response highlights the effectiveness of the animation as a tool for enhancing the overall impact and understanding of the installation. As some of the reflections of the Participant had a metaphorical nature, i.e the snails crawling on the brain, it was easier to convey this using animation instead of real footage. So, by saying this, Participant 3 mostly confirmed that we had portrayed their experience in a truthful way. They thought however that in their experience, the doctor's office felt more clinical and did not have as nice chairs,

Det virkede meget mere fjernt og klinisk end det nødvendigvis gør i kortfilmen” and “Der var ikke nogen komfortabel stol, bare en basic kontorstol så ingen komfort som i filmen og ikke helt samme nærhed. Hun sad ved et skrivebord, der var ca 2m imellem os, og skrev ned på en blok papir.

This suggests that the film might have failed to capture the extent of the monotonous and uncomfortable atmosphere that was present in the original doctor's office. The lack of emotional resonance in the installation could undermine its effectiveness in conveying the intended message and connecting with the visitors on a deeper level. We focused on the feelings, thoughts, and metaphorical images of the account by the participant, and as they had not described the specific

look of a psychiatrist's office, we based it on a mood board we collected on how a doctor's office could look like. We did not aim to create a documentary style video with exact representations of a psychiatrist's office but tried to interpret the images in our own way.

In retrospect we might have considered making the appearance of the office more clinical, because it adds to the emotional layer of the scene. If we had chosen a more uncomfortable looking chair, it might have conveyed more of the discomfort felt by the Participant.

We excluded some of the elements from the reflection of Participant 3, of what she talked about, for example they talked about feeling an ever present “beast” (red. “bæst”) lurking, but their answer indicated that we still managed to create a more or less true representation.

Some parts will inevitably be different or lost from the participants' experience when making an interpretation. The participant made an autoethnographic reflection and put emphasis on the things that they found important and remembered, so there will be things that only they know about their experience, that they did not describe in their reflections. When the autoethnographic account is transferred to another person to interpret, the person to whom it is transferred may lack some surrounding knowledge and nuances of different feelings; Those nuances that you can only describe when doing traditional autoethnography, where you as the researcher explore your own experiences.

One of the benefits of doing autoethnographic research is that you have free and easy data available all the time, and you can refine the data over and over and dive deeper, and by using autoethnographic reflections from another person, we lost that advantage. However, we kept the advantage of obtaining data that was more freely and personally generated.

5.2 Evaluating Visitors of the Installation

5.2.1 Preparation of Questionnaires

In addition to asking the person whose thoughts we had interpreted, we asked the visitors some questions to gauge whether we had been able to convey the thoughts and feelings we sought to portray, in a way that the visitors could clearly see. Furthermore, we thought it would be

interesting to see whether visitors with experience themselves, were able to relate to the installation.

The questionnaire was kept short, to minimise the disturbance of the flow of visitors of the installation and increase the likelihood of people wanting to spend time answering it.

It was designed to be handed out to the visitors prior to entering the space and interacting with the installation, and then upon exiting the space, the visitors were asked to look through their answers from before and add or change anything.

The questionnaire featured some demographic questions about gender, age, and occupation, but also a question about whether the visitor had close experience with the psychiatric system to check if they already had pre-existing knowledge about the feelings of being involved in the Danish psychiatric system.

The questionnaire also featured both quantitative and a qualitative question (see appendix 8 for full questionair) In the quantitative part, the respondents were asked to cross off all the words they felt described the process of getting *help* in the Danish psychiatric system. We made a multiple-choice setup, to make it easy for respondents to fill it out and so we would have some concise data. For this part, we had included five words relating to our three topics “help”, “frustration” and “time” to check whether people would choose those words to describe the experience and then we had an additional ten words to choose from (see appendix 9 for checklist). We expected people to cross off the words “frustrating”, “powerless”, “helpless”, “slow-moving” and “hopeless”, as they were representational of the three themes.

The qualitative question concerned what the respondent thought it felt like to *wait* to get assessed and treated. This was to give the respondent an opportunity to expand on their thoughts.

5.2.2 Data from Questionnaires

We made an analysis of the questionnaire with the basis of seeing whether we had been able to convey the themes we had extracted from the self-reflection. Many of the visitors expressed either explicitly or implicitly the five words we had expected to see.

One visitor, who did not know if they were next of kins to anyone in the psychiatric system, expressed before they saw the installation.

Jeg kunne forestille mig, at det er utroligt frustrerende at skulle række ud efter hjælp,
... Og det at vente på at komme igennem, må føles utroligt håbløst og om hjælpen
overhovedet kommer, må gøre at man ikke føler sig set og hørt.

and then after watching put an emphasis on the feeling of emptiness followed by waiting time. This visitor expresses exactly the themes we tried to convey.

When we looked at the added words, we saw that people had a tendency to add words, like helpless, slow-moving, frustration, and powerless, which all responded with our expectations. This indicates that the words they chose corresponded with our thematic basis of the video. This means our installation successfully conveyed the experience of participant 3, which means that our contribution to the artistic dimension seems successful.

Overall, the consensus was that the installation has some truth in its representation of the experience participant 3 have in the Danish psychiatric system.

5.2.3 Problem with the Questionnaire

We analysed the answers from our questionnaire and realised that they had a different focus compared to what we wanted to achieve. The focus of the questionnaire ended up being more about an educational aspect of the project in terms of what the visitor thought it would feel like to be assessed in the system and whether that changed after interacting with the installation. This meant analysing the questionnaires became difficult and are therefore lacking crucial aspects, as only a few of the responses can usefully be used in the analysis.

Our actual focus of the project was to figure out if the design choices we have made are corresponding to the self-reflection made by the participant. The questionnaires are meant to support whether it makes sense to use the autoethnographic methods second-hand, because we need to create a true representation of the participants' experiences.

Since our main focus in the project was whether this second-hand application could serve as a valuable design method, we instead needed to ask people which feelings and themes they thought

were present in the installation and have them cross off these words after their interaction with the installation.

5.2.4 Observations of the Interactions

As our problem concerned the thoughts and opinions of participant 3 and the visitors of the installation, we did not initially plan to look at observations from people's interactions as a part of the evaluation. However, we did notice a few noteworthy things during the exhibition of the installation.

Only one person could interact with the watering can at the time and initially we had thought that it would be a challenge that more people might go in together. However, what we saw was that the people interacting with the watering can were often so focused on the act of watering the flower, that they often did not see that water appeared on the screen, causing the flower to start flourishing. When other people were in the room with them, they would point it out to them, which was helpful to the person that was doing the watering. This meant that while we initially intended the installation to work best for only one person, it seemed that smaller groups were faster and more likely to understand the interaction.

When the looped video of the flower transitioned into the main video, and the plant started flourishing, people did not immediately understand that the interactive part was over. The shots looked a lot like each other, with the same plant, and some people thought that they could or were supposed to water it more and they were confused until the next scene started.

Another observation was the strong impact the installation had on people. We observed that some people entering together comforted each other while watching the video with a hand on the shoulder or a hug.

A group of three were cautious of the installation, even before entering the installation, due to a trigger warning placed by the questionnaires. Two from the group held each other, visibly affected by the installation, when watching the video. The third ended up leaving early, visibly very affected by the video.

We had not considered how much the installation would relate to the people that already had experience with mental health problems and the psychiatric system. A lot of people explicitly called the experience of watching the video of the installation “strong”, and it sparked dialogue. A foreign student of social work told us to publicise the installation, so that more people could get to experience it. Someone suggested that we might exhibit it in hospitals or schools. This made us think of displaying the installation in other contexts, where we could maybe reach more people.

5.3 Synthesising of Evaluation Answers

In this section we would like to discuss whether we have succeeded in creating something that accurately represents participant 3’s own experience and whether or not our design process was a good way to achieve this. Based on the data from our evaluation of participant 3 and visitors, participant 3 said that they could relate to the drained and careless expression of the actor, and visitors of the installation said that we effectively portrayed the frustration and powerlessness one may feel, being involved with the psychiatric system. This implies, along with the observations and remarks of visitors; being visibly emotionally affected and calling the work strong, that we were able to convey important feelings and themes from the self-reflections of participant 3.

When collaborating with the third participant we encountered a few issues. First the participant had difficulties with understanding what they were supposed to do because they are not familiar with the auto-ethnographic methods. This issue stems from the nature of the self-reflection guide. We wanted to make the guide as open-ended as possible to ensure their self-reflection did not have too many constraints but this in turn made it harder for the participant.

As mentioned in our interview section [3.1], there are issues with using data from someone you already know because this could result in you unintentionally filling in some gaps. However, we did not see this as a big issue as the majority of the group were not close with the participant and we analysed their self-reflection individually and then synthesised together. As such we were able to minimise any bias that might have occurred. Additionally, we viewed our connection to participant

3 as a strength, because it made us feel a strong sense of responsibility to create a true representation.

When evaluating the data, we found that our questionnaires had the wrong focus. The focus we should have had was asking visitors whether they recognised the themes we wanted to highlight. That would have provided us with useful data.

It is important to take in consideration that since we had a personal connection to the participant, they might have been more inclined to give a positive evaluation on our project.

6 Future Work

This project serves as an overview of what the process of using autoethnographic reflections second-hand can look like for researching artists wanting to create something visual. It can be used as a point of reference to others, who are considering doing the same thing, so they can decide whether it is the right approach for them.

Initially, this project was intended to have been more extensive. In the future it would be possible to make more artefact-video-combinations, including more stories about the psychiatric system. The installation is easily expandable in that way, and it would be possible to build on the work. If we were to choose to expand the process, we now have a replicable recipe that we would be able to apply to new cases.

Another idea of expansion could be to display the installation in other venues. This could be sustainability conferences, with focus on health and social sustainability, schools, hospitals, or cultural values. Apart from serving as a way to evaluate whether autoethnographic methods could be used second hand, the installation can also be used to create awareness about the condition of the psychiatric system and the people trying to get help.

7 Conclusion

In this report we presented an exploration of using autoethnographic methods to collect first-hand experience data from a participant, which culminated in an artistic visual-interactive work called *HOPE*.

We evaluated whether this method was a good way of representing a personal experience visually by asking the participant if the work represented their feelings. What we found was that the work was received well, and the participant felt that it was a true representation, with a few exceptions. Furthermore, visitors at the installation were asked to fill out a questionnaire, reviewing whether they could recognise the feelings expressed in the installation. Visitors of the installation with experience within the system could also recognise the feelings of frustration, powerlessness, slow-moving, fast-moving, helplessness and hopelessness in the installation.

Based on the evaluation of this installation, this alternative use of autoethnographic methods was successful in conveying the lived experience of a person within the Danish psychiatric system through an interactive-video installation.

This exploration created a framework for working as a researching artist without first-hand experience within their research topic.

This work is a contribution to the ongoing discussions of how you can use autoethnography in visual arts. In a broader sense we believe that this project has contributed to the discussion of how autoethnography and art meet and collaborate.

8 Reference List

- Adafruit BNO055 Absolute Orientation Sensor. (u.å.). Adafruit.
<https://learn.adafruit.com/adafruit-bno055-absolute-orientation-sensor/overview>
- Ahmed, S. U. (2018). Interaction and Interactivity: In the Context of Digital Interactive Art Installation. I M. Kurosu (Red.), *Human-Computer Interaction. Interaction in Context* (Bd. 10902, s. 241–257). Springer International Publishing. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-91244-8_20
- Behar, R. (1999). ETHNOGRAPHY: Cherishing Our Second-Fiddle Genre. *Journal of Contemporary Ethnography*, 28(5), 472–484. <https://doi.org/10.1177/089124199129023604>
- Blandford, A., Furniss, D., & Makri, S. (2016). *Qualitative HCI research: Going behind the scenes*. Morgan & Claypool Publishers.
- Bochner, A. P., & Ellis, C. (2003). An Introduction to the Arts and Narrative Research: Art as Inquiry. I *Qualitative Inquiry* (Bd. 9, s. 506–514).
<http://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/1077800403254394>
- Clip Studio Paint (1.11.4.202110151505). (u.å.). [Windows]. CELSYS. Inc.
<https://www.clipstudio.net/en/>
- Cooper, R., & Lilyea, B. (2022). I’m Interested in Autoethnography, but How Do I Do It? *The Qualitative Report*. <https://doi.org/10.46743/2160-3715/2022.5288>
- Eisner, E. W. (1997). The Promise and Perils of Alternative Forms of Data Representation. *Educational Researcher*, 26(6), 4–10. <https://doi.org/10.3102/0013189X026006004>
- Finley, S. (2011). *Critical Arts-Based Inquiry: The Pedagogy and Performance of a Radical Ethical Aesthetic* (s. 435–450).
- Fry, B., & Reas, C. (u.å.). *Processing* (4.2). <https://processing.org/>
- Fujihata, M. (u.å.). On interactivity. I *Takeover: Who’s doing the art of tomorrow* (Bd. 2001). https://webarchive.ars.electronica.art/en/archiv_files/20011/E2001_316.pdf
- Fuse Arts. (u.å.). Hentet 7. marts 2023, fra <https://www.fusearts.org/blackout-immersive/>
- Gillham, B. (2008). *Developing a Questionnaire* (2nd ed). Bloomsbury Publishing.
- Goal 3 | Department of Economic and Social Affairs. (u.å.). Hentet 7. marts 2023, fra <https://sdgs.un.org/goals/goal3>
- Hernandez, H. C., Faith Ngunjiri, Kathy-Ann C. (2016). *Collaborative Autoethnography*. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315432137>
- Holman Jones, S. L., Adams, T. E., & Ellis, C. (2013). *Handbook of autoethnography*. Left Coast Press, Inc.
- Howard-Butler, S. (2017, oktober 6). An art installation that improves mental health. *HealthWellNext*. <https://medium.com/healthwellnext/an-art-installation-that-improves-mental-health-2a58a08e8353>
- Librarians, H. L. (u.å.). *LibGuides: Qualitative study design: Grounded theory*. Hentet 30. maj 2023, fra <https://deakin.libguides.com/qualitative-study-designs/grounded-theory>

- LLC, C. P. (u.å.). *What is a Storyboard? — Storyboard Graphic Organizer | StoryboardThat*. Storyboard That. Hentet 30. maj 2023, fra <https://www.storyboardthat.com/articles/e/what-is-a-storyboard>
- M5Stack Atom Motion Kit*. (u.å.). M5Stack. <https://shop.m5stack.com/products/atom-motion-kit-with-motor-and-servo-driver-stm32fo>
- MAYA* (2023.1). (u.å.). [Windows]. Autodesk. <https://www.autodesk.dk/products/maya/overview?term=1-YEAR&tab=subscription>
- McAllister, B. J. (2014). Narrative in Concrete / Concrete in Narrative: Visual Poetry and Narrative Theory. *Narrative*, 22(2), 234–251.
- Norman, D. A. (1999). Affordance, conventions, and design. *Interactions*, 6(3), 38–43. <https://doi.org/10.1145/301153.301168>
- Patienter må stå i kø over et år: Psykiaternes ventetider hamrer i vejret*. (2022, august 11). DR. <https://www.dr.dk/nyheder/indland/patienter-maa-staa-i-koe-over-et-aar-psykiaternes-ventetider-hamrer-i-vejret>
- Saldaña, J. (2011). *Fundamentals of qualitative research*. Oxford University Press.
- Systematic Reviews*. (2023, maj 22). [Library subject guides]. RMIT. <https://rmit.libguides.com/systematicreviews/synthesise>
- SAARDA, & Fowler, Ian. (2017). *Hearing voices of support* [Interactive art installation].
- THE 17 GOALS | Sustainable Development*. (u.å.). Hentet 27. maj 2023, fra <https://sdgs.un.org/goals>
- TouchDesigner* (Version 2022-32050). (u.å.). [Python; Windows]. Derivative. <https://derivative.ca/>
- Vistisen, P. (2016). *Sketching with animation: Using animation to portray fictional realities – aimed at becoming Factual*. Aalborg Universitetsforlag.

9 Appendix

Appendix 1-10

Appendix 1 - 10 for *HOPE* can be viewed in *Digital Eksamen*

Appendix 11

Video showcasing the interactive video installation *HOPE* can be found in *Digital Eksamen*